Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam

MGU-UGP(Honours)

Fifth Semester Examination

(2024 Admission Onwards)

MG5DSCENG302– READING SHAKESPEARE

Duration: 2 Hrs.
Maximum Marks: 70

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Learning domains	**Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Skills (S), Interest (I) and Appreciation (Ap)**

PART A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer **All** Questions. Each question carries **1** mark

1. What is Lord Capulet's initial response when Paris asks for Juliet's hand in marriage in Act 1, Scene 2? [K] [CO1]

    a. He immediately agrees and sets the wedding for the following day.
    b. He states that Juliet is too young ("a stranger in the world") and asks Paris to wait two years.
    c. He rejects Paris because of a ongoing political conflict.
    d. He asks Paris to consult Lady Capulet first.

2. What reason does Lord Capulet give to Tybalt for refusing to allow an attack on Romeo at the party? [K] [CO1]

    a. Capulet fears Romeo's bodyguards will defeat Tybalt.
    b. Capulet respects Romeo's reputation in Verona as a "virtuous and well-govern'd youth" and will not disrupt his feast.
    c. Capulet secretly wants Romeo to marry Juliet.
    d. Capulet is bound by a secret financial agreement with Lord Montague.

3. "What political and social motive convinces Friar Laurence to agree to perform the secret marriage of Romeo and Juliet? [K] [CO1]

a. He hopes to gain financial wealth from both aristocratic families.
b. He hopes the alliance will turn the households' rancor into pure love (*"to turn your households' rancour to pure love"*).
c. He wants to challenge the legal authority of Prince Escalus.
d. He plans to send the couple into exile immediately after the wedding.

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4. Where does Romeo hide after killing Tybalt in Act 3, Scene 3? [K] [CO2]

a. In his father Lord Montague's estate.

a. In Friar Laurence's cell.
b. In an abandoned graveyard outside Verona.
c. Inside Juliet's bedchamber.

5. Why is Paris visiting Friar Laurence's cell at the beginning of Act 4, Scene 1? [K] [CO 3]

a. To seek spiritual advice about his military duties.
b. To make official arrangements for his upcoming wedding to Juliet.
c. To ask the Friar to forgive Romeo's sins.
d. To request a secret blessing for Lord Capulet.

6. Who brings the news of Juliet's supposed death to Romeo in Mantua at the start of Act 5, Scene 1? [K] [CO3]
   a. Friar John
   b. Balthasar
   c. Benvoli
   d. Peter
7. What psychological term does Kahn use to describe the process by which young men in Verona transition from childhood to male adulthood? [U] [CO4]
   a. Psychological regression.

   b. Coming of age (Passage to manhood within the patriarchal order).

   c. Social alienation.

d. Spiritual enlightenment.

8. In Prusko's essay, how does youth culture in Verona attempt to carve out its own agency amidst adult control? [K] [CO4]

   a. By establishing formal political parties in the Veronese senate.

   b. By appropriating boundary spaces (orchards, balconies, masked balls) to create temporary pockets of privacy.

   c. By leaving Verona en masse to settle in Mantua.

   d. By appealing directly to the Pope for legal protection.

9. How does Lord Capulet react in Act 3, Scene 5 when Juliet refuses to marry Paris? [U] [CO 2]
   a. He calmly agrees to let her make her own choice.
   b. He reacts with explosive rage, threatening to disown her and drag her to church on a hurdle.
   c. He asks Lady Capulet to convince her gently.
   d. He asks Friar Laurence to grant her a blessing.

10. What is Friar Laurence doing when Romeo first arrives at his cell in Act 2, Scene 3? [U] [CO 2]

   a. Reading a legal document from Prince Escalus.
   b. Gathering medicinal plants and herbs in a wicker basket.
   c. Writing a letter to Lord Montague.
   d. Performing a religious mass service.

[10x1=10

PART B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **6** questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. Explain how the atmosphere of the Capulet feast changes when Tybalt discovers Romeo's presence. [U] [CO1]

12. Describe the instructions Romeo gives to the Nurse in Act 2, Scene 4 regarding the secret wedding ceremony at Friar Laurence’s cell. [U] [CO2]

13. Explain the plan outlined by Friar Laurence to resolve Romeo's banishment and reunite him with Juliet. [U] [CO 2]

14. Evaluate the dramatic shift in tone from festive preparation to mourning in Act 4, Scenes 4 and 5. [E] [CO3]

15. Apply the concept of dramatic irony to Romeo’s final speech in Juliet’s tomb regarding her physical appearance. [A] [CO3]

16. Explain Kahn's argument regarding how the feud forces young men into a false dichotomy between "effeminate" love and "masculine" violence. [U] [CO4]

17. Analyze the differing perspectives on marriage held by Lady Capulet and the Nurse. [An] [CO1]

18. Describe the instructions Romeo gives to the Nurse regarding the secret wedding ceremony at Friar Laurence’s cell. [U] [CO2]

19. Explain Prusko's view on how the lack of private space shapes the urgency and speed of Romeo and Juliet's romantic relationship. [U] [CO4]

[6x5=30]

PART C

ESSAY

Answer any **2** questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Analyze how Shakespeare juxtaposes the birth of romantic love with the threat of violent feud, examining how the dual forces of Eros (love) and Thanatos

(death) are structurally integrated. [An] [CO1]

21. Detail how Act 3 transforms comic tropes (secret wedding, witty banter) into tragedy (murders, banishment, forced marriage, despair), sealing the lovers'

downward fate. [U] [CO2]

22. Critically evaluate the moral dilemmas and ethical responsibility surrounding the tragic outcome in Act 5. To what extent should the catastrophe be blamed on Friar Laurence’s flawed scheme, individual choices, or systemic societal hatred? [E] [CO3]

23. Explain how Kahn critiques the institution of fatherhood in Renaissance Verona through the actions of Lord Capulet. How does paternal authority enforce

female subjection through domestic tyranny? [U] [CO4]

[2x15=30]